

WITNESS / MULTIPLE

Commission 05 — THE SCAR ROOM — Field Document

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“Humane memory is not memory that never changes. It is memory whose authority can change without requiring history to lie.”

Central Finding — Commission 05. If memory can be contested, how should correction leave a trace without becoming a permanent sentence? The investigation began as a study of correction. It became a study of temporal authority: *For how long, and with what force, should a remembered representation be allowed to influence the future?*

DISCOVERIES

- 01** Correction should not necessarily preserve the corrected content. The fact that a correction occurred may deserve preservation even when original content does not.
- 02** Revision provenance and content persistence are separable. A system can preserve evidence that a representation was changed without requiring the representation itself to remain permanently visible.
- 03** Archival existence does not imply present authority. Something may remain historically part of record while losing permission to define the person.
- 04** Privacy status and epistemic status are separate. True and withdrawn. False and historically significant.
- 05** Corrections themselves must remain contestable. A correction is another claim about the record.
- 06** Time alone cannot determine when accountability fades. Growth, forgiveness, accountability, and restitution do not share same clock.
- 07** The burden of correction should not automatically fall on person represented.
- 08** Some memories can remain historically available while becoming behaviorally quiet. Machine memory is active.
- 09** Withdrawal can preserve evidence of absence without preserving withdrawn content. “Something was removed here.”
- 10** The scar belongs where representation failed — not automatically on human. If model failed, mark model. If